

BASIC ELECTRONICS COURSES CAN BE OF HELP

Training institutes not only provide finishing touch to aspiring engineers but also help the industry in improving the productivity of engineering professionals



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You have the engineering degree from a reputed institute with great grades and a strong list of references, but you still don't get the call from a potential employer. The employer rejects your application as he is looking for a trained individual who can handle the situations from day one. He does not have enough time to train you. So it's time you enroll for a good training institute to hone your skills and increase your chances of grabbing an attractive job offer.

Bridging the skill gap

Among industry veterans, there is a clear consensus about the gap that exists between the quality of knowledge

imparted by the engineering institutes and the industry requirements. In other words, the pace at which the curriculum develops in engineering colleges is slower than the pace at which the industry advances. Enrolling in a suitable training institute helps the engineering aspirants to bridge the skill gap.

"Updating the curriculum to reflect the industry's needs is the first step. Over the last decade, technologies such as electronics and computer science have grown both in breadth and depth. It is not easy to formulate an undergraduate curriculum in these areas. It is hard to decide what to include and what to leave out. We see two extremes in our colleges today—the IITs have a single undergraduate programme in

'electrical engineering,' whereas most colleges have split the EE programme into electronics, telecommunication, power engineering and so on," says Dr C.P. Ravikumar, technical director, University Relations, Texas Instruments India.

"There are equally powerful arguments for (and against) a 'breadth-oriented' programme and a 'depth-oriented' programme. Hiring managers who are looking out for industry-ready engineers could look for depth in a specific topic. Such managers could have apprehensions about a breadth-oriented programme. However, breadth cannot be ignored entirely since system design is becoming more and more inter-disciplinary. Perhaps, there is place for both breadth-oriented and depth-oriented programmes and colleges must evolve their programmes in cooperation with industries that hire from them. This underlines the importance of industry-academia interaction," he adds.

Having defined a curriculum, the more important question is "how to deliver this to the students?" "Due to the rapid expansion in the field of technical education, engineering colleges in India do not have the required number of qualified faculty members. This becomes evident when an interview panel faces graduating students or when we review contest entries. There are some solutions to this problem, such as use of technologies like audio/video conferencing, use of Open Source courseware available from reputed universities, invite experts as visiting faculty, organise faculty internships, conduct faculty development